



HIGHER HEALTH

2024

POLICY ON LANGUAGE



Policy on Language

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Signature	
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Glossary

“Curriculum” means a statement of the training structure and expected methods of learning and teaching that underpin a qualification or part-qualification (skills programme) to facilitate a more general understanding of its implementation in an education system

“e-learning” means a mode of teaching and learning that makes use of technology-mediated features.

“entry-level requirements” means the minimum academic knowledge and/ or practical competencies, and/or work experience that a learner must have completed in order to be admitted for study towards a qualification or part-qualification; this may include recognition of other forms of prior learning such as non-formal and informal learning and work experience deemed as comparable for entry delivery of the learning being assessed.

“Learner” is an inclusive term referring to anyone learning, including pupils, students, apprentices, interns, learners in learnerships, people doing training, and people learning non-formally and informally as well as people enrolled for particular qualifications or part-qualifications, and people learning in contact, distance, and self-study contexts at all levels in the system.

“Official languages” means the twelve official languages of South Africa.

“Skills Programme” means a QCTO-accredited learning programme that is occupationally based and which, when completed, may constitute credits towards a qualification registered on the NQF.

1. Background

Higher Health is a non-profit organisation focused on the health and wellness of the youth in the post-school education and training (PSET) sector. Higher Health's model of delivering health and wellness services is to empower PSET learners to take charge of their health and wellness, through education and knowledge. Higher Health's programmes are intense, and are delivered in-person, as well as online through social media, Higher Health's website, through radio and television interviews, and through Higher Health's flagship products, its e-learning Civic and Soft Skills Programme, which the QCTO accredited as a NQF Level 5 Skills Programme.

2. Purpose

- a) The purpose of this policy is to outline Higher Health's view on the use of language in its communication on various platforms.
- b) This policy aims to provide a framework for the use of the 12 official South African languages for official correspondence in which the following principles are upheld:
 - i. Improved communication with different groups of stakeholders;
 - ii. Maintenance of the organisational culture of effective communication; and
 - iii. Improved understanding of the message/content communicated.

3. Legislative and Regulatory Framework

This policy must be read in conjunction with

- I. Constitution of the Republic of South Africa Act, 1996; and
- II. Use of Official Languages Act, 12 of 2012
 - a. Section 6 of the Constitution recognises 11 official languages in the Republic. Subsequent to the drafting of the Constitution, South Africa also recognised Sign Language as the twelfth official language.
 - b. Sections 4(1) and 7(a) of the Use of Official Languages Act, 12 of 2012 requires the adoption of a Language Policy and the establishment of a Language Unit.

4. Scope and Application

This policy applies to Higher Health's communication on its different platforms, to its different stakeholder groups.

5. Policy Principles

Higher Health hereby adopts the following languages for official correspondence, as required in terms of Section 4(2)(b) of the Act:

- a. English is the language of choice for communication with all government officials, including those within PSET institutions, and Higher Health's governance structures.
- b. Translation services may be procured, should it become necessary to correspond in any language, other than in English, for government-to-government communication.
- c. The target audience may be considered before determining the language to be used in communicating with the broader public.
- d. Reasonable steps, practicality, and the nature of correspondence will be taken into consideration in choosing the official language(s) to be used in the production of content for public consumption.
- e. English will be used in communicating with the public when language heterogeneity is envisaged among the target audience.
- f. Official publications such as notices on the website, strategic plan and newsletters, will be written in English.
- g. Translation of publications to other official languages will be made on request, taking the cost implications into consideration.
- h. Internal communication is conducted in English and records of all proceedings are captured in English.
- i. International communication is conducted in English.
- j. Social media posts are communicated in English; however specific video messages may be translated into other official languages, as needed.

6. Communication with PSET staff and students

- a. Higher Health's flagship offering to students and staff within the PSET sector, is its accredited Civic and Health Skills Programme, pegged at NQF Level 5.
 - i. This programme is currently offered in English with some Sign Language options available. Plans are underway to offer the curriculum in all official languages, beginning with isiZulu, Afrikaans, and Sesotho, and gradually adding the other official languages.
 - ii. The formative and summative tests for the curriculum, will also be offered in different official languages.

- iii. Once the curriculum is offered internationally, the content will be translated into other languages, as required.
- b. Higher Health also offers face-to-face training and intervention programmes.
 - i. These interventions may be offered in the language most spoken at a particular PSET institution.
 - ii. Posters and other printed material may be provided in English and a second language that is generally spoken at that institution.
 - iii. Where possible, video clips will contain sub-titles in one other official language.

7. Complaints regarding the Use of Official Languages

All complaints related to the use of languages at Higher Health and/or the implementation of this Policy can be directed in writing to the CEO by emailing info@higherhealth.ac.za .

8. Language Unit

The Communications Manager is appointed to perform the functions of the Language Unit, as prescribed in section 12(4) of the Act.